Dough Kneader



Category: **Food Processing & Kitchen** Type: **Full SOP** Priority: **High** 4 labs

Covers these lab items: Dough Kneading Machine; Dough Mixer / Blender; Spiral mixer

What it is used for

A dough kneader mixes and develops dough ingredients to achieve a consistent texture for food preparation. Correct loading, speed selection, and hygienic cleaning help produce uniform dough while reducing mechanical and food-safety risks.

Main parts

- Mixing bowl holds the flour, water, and other ingredients.
- Kneading hook or mixing tool combines and develops the dough.
- Drive motor supplies power to the mixing mechanism.
- Speed selector or control panel sets the operating speed.
- Bowl guard or safety cover helps prevent access to moving parts.
- Bowl locking mechanism secures the bowl during operation.
- Timer controls the mixing duration on equipped models.
- Frame and base support the machine during kneading.

Before you start

1. Read the operating manual and confirm the machine capacity for the planned batch.
2. Inspect the bowl, kneading tool, guard, power cord, and controls for damage.
3. Ensure the bowl and food-contact parts are clean and dry.
4. Measure ingredients according to the approved recipe and batch size.
5. Check that the kneading tool and bowl are correctly fitted and locked.
6. Clear the work area and keep loose clothing, jewellery, and hands away from moving parts.

How to use

1. Switch off the machine before installing the bowl or kneading tool.
2. Add ingredients in the order specified by the recipe or manufacturer.
3. Secure the bowl and fit the safety guard before operation.
4. Select the recommended speed and mixing time for the dough type.
5. Start the machine and monitor the dough through the guard without reaching inside.
6. Stop the machine before scraping the bowl or adjusting ingredients.
7. Check dough consistency and continue kneading only for the required time.
8. Switch off and isolate the power before removing the bowl or kneading tool.
9. Transfer the dough using clean food-safe utensils and avoid contact with non-food surfaces.
10. Clean and dry the bowl, kneading tool, guard, and food-contact areas after use.

⚠ Safety

- Never put hands or utensils into the bowl while the machine is running.
- Do not bypass the bowl guard or safety interlock.
- Switch off and disconnect power before clearing jams or changing attachments.
- Keep the machine away from water near electrical components.
- Do not exceed the manufacturer's batch capacity or recommended operating time.
- Use safe lifting practices when handling heavy bowls or dough batches.

Care & storage

- Wash food-contact parts using approved food-safe cleaning methods.
- Dry components thoroughly before reassembly or storage.
- Inspect the kneading tool, bowl lock, guard, and power cord regularly.
- Arrange authorised servicing if the motor overheats, makes unusual noise, or fails to stop correctly.

Common mistakes to avoid

- Overfilling the bowl beyond the rated batch capacity.
- Starting the machine before securing the bowl and guard.
- Changing ingredients or clearing dough while the machine is running.
- Leaving moisture or dough residue on parts after cleaning.

Disclaimer: This SOP is prepared from general information available on the internet. For detailed instructions, refer to the manufacturer's original manual / file.